RX-001

The social worker's role with psychiatric medication?

RX-002

A client wants to stop a medication. Social worker's response?

RX-003

When should a social worker contact or refer to the prescriber?

RX-004

Serotonin syndrome: typical cause?

RX-005

Serotonin syndrome: signs?

RX-006

Neuroleptic malignant syndrome: cause and signs?

RX-007

Serotonin syndrome versus NMS: quick discriminator?

RX-008

Lithium toxicity: warning signs?

RX-002

Explore the reasons and encourage the client to discuss it with the prescriber; respect the client's choice. Do not advise stopping or changing the dose.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-001

Educate in general terms, monitor side effects and adherence, coordinate with the prescriber and advocate. Never prescribe, adjust doses or tell a client to stop.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-004

Combining serotonergic drugs (SSRIs or SNRIs with MAOIs, tramadol, triptans, linezolid, St. John's wort, MDMA, dextromethorphan) or a dose increase.

Boyer, E. W., & Shannon, M. (2005). The serotonin syndrome. New Engla...

RX-003

New or worsening side effects, nonadherence, no improvement, emerging suicidality, mania or psychosis, pregnancy, new medications, or a wish to stop.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-006

Antipsychotics (new or higher dose). Develops over days: high fever, severe 'lead-pipe' rigidity, confusion, unstable blood pressure and pulse. Potentially fatal; emergency care.

Strawn, J. R., Keck, P. E., & Caroff, S. N. (2007). Neuroleptic malignant sy...

RX-005

Rapid onset, often within hours: agitation or confusion, fever, sweating, diarrhea, dilated pupils, tremor, and clonus or overactive reflexes. Emergency care.

Boyer, E. W., & Shannon, M. (2005). The serotonin syndrome. New Engla...

RX-008

Vomiting, diarrhea, coarse tremor, sluggishness and unsteadiness, progressing to confusion, slurred speech and seizures. Get emergency care.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-007

Serotonin syndrome: fast onset, clonus and overactive reflexes, serotonergic drugs. NMS: slower onset, rigidity with slow reflexes, dopamine blockers.

Boyer, E. W., & Shannon, M. (2005). The serotonin syndrome. New Engla...

RX-009

What raises lithium levels toward toxicity?

RX-010

Lithium monitoring and common side effects?

RX-011

Hypertensive crisis on an MAOI: signs and cause?

RX-012

Anticholinergic toxicity: signs and common causes?

RX-013

Stevens-Johnson syndrome: signs and linked drugs?

RX-014

Opioid overdose signs and response?

RX-015

Naloxone availability?

RX-016

Acute dystonia?

RX-010

Narrow therapeutic range: blood levels plus kidney and thyroid tests. Side effects: thirst, frequent urination, fine tremor, weight gain, hypothyroidism.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-009

Dehydration (heat, vomiting, low fluid or salt intake), NSAIDs, ACE inhibitors, thiazide diuretics and kidney problems.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-012

Hot, dry, flushed skin, dilated pupils, confusion, urinary retention. Causes: tricyclics, diphenhydramine, benztropine and many sleep aids. Emergency.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-011

Severe headache, stiff neck, palpitations, very high blood pressure, usually after tyramine-rich foods (aged cheese, cured meats) or certain drugs. Emergency.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-014

Pinpoint pupils, unresponsiveness, slow or stopped breathing. Call 911 and give naloxone.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-013

Painful spreading rash, blistering and mouth or eye sores; emergency. Linked to lamotrigine and carbamazepine, among others.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-016

Hours to days after starting an antipsychotic: painful muscle spasms of the neck, jaw or eyes (oculogyric crisis). Needs urgent treatment.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Medication-Induced Movement Disorders: Medicat...

RX-015

Reverses opioid overdose. A nasal spray version was approved for over-the-counter sale in 2023.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2023). FDA approves first over-the-c...

RX-017

Akathisia?

RX-018

Medication-induced parkinsonism?

RX-019

Tardive dyskinesia?

RX-020

Which antipsychotics carry the highest movement-disorder risk?

RX-021

Main risk of second-generation antipsychotics?

RX-022

Clozapine: when used and key risks?

RX-023

Antipsychotics in older adults with dementia?

RX-024

Long-acting injectable antipsychotics: main advantage?

RX-018

Within weeks: tremor, rigidity, slowed movement, shuffling gait, masklike face.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Medication-Induced Movement Disorders: Medicat...

RX-017

Inner restlessness and an urge to keep moving after starting or raising an antipsychotic. Often mistaken for anxiety; linked to nonadherence and suicidality. Report to prescriber.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Medication-Induced Movement Disorders: Medicat...

RX-020

High-potency first-generation drugs such as haloperidol. Second-generation drugs carry lower, but not zero, risk.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-019

After months or years: involuntary movements of the mouth, tongue and face (lip smacking). May be irreversible; monitored with the AIMS.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Medication-Induced Movement Disorders: Tardive...

RX-022

Most effective for treatment-resistant schizophrenia and reduces suicidal behavior. Risks: severe neutropenia (blood counts monitored), seizures, myocarditis, constipation.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-021

Metabolic effects: weight gain, diabetes and high lipids (especially olanzapine and clozapine). Monitor weight, glucose and lipids.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-024

They support adherence for clients who struggle with daily pills or have limited insight into their illness.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-023

Boxed warning: increased risk of death when used for dementia-related psychosis.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2008). Information for healthcare pro...

RX-025

Antidepressant boxed warning?

RX-026

How long until antidepressants work?

RX-027

Antidepressant discontinuation syndrome?

RX-028

Which SSRI causes the least discontinuation trouble, and why?

RX-029

Antidepressant given to someone with undiagnosed bipolar disorder?

RX-030

Common SSRI side effects?

RX-031

Bupropion: notable features?

RX-032

Mirtazapine and trazodone?

RX-026

Usually several weeks (often 2-6 or more) for full effect; side effects may appear before benefits.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-025

Increased suicidal thinking and behavior in children, adolescents and young adults (under 25). Monitor closely early in treatment and after dose changes.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2007). Antidepressant labeling: boxe...

RX-028

Fluoxetine, because its long half-life tapers itself.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-027

After an abrupt stop (especially paroxetine or venlafaxine): flu-like feelings, insomnia, nausea, dizziness, 'brain zaps,' irritability. Taper with the prescriber.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Other Adverse Effects of Medication: Antidepressa...

RX-030

Nausea, sexual dysfunction, sleep changes, headache. Sexual side effects are a frequent reason people stop.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-029

It can trigger mania or hypomania. Screen for past episodes and route concerns to the prescriber.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-032

Both sedating. Mirtazapine causes weight gain; trazodone is often used for sleep and rarely causes priapism.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-031

Activating, no sexual side effects, also used to quit smoking. Lowers the seizure threshold, so it's avoided with seizures or eating disorders.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-033

Tricyclic antidepressants: key danger?

RX-034

MAOIs: key cautions?

RX-035

Esketamine nasal spray?

RX-036

St. John's wort: interactions?

RX-037

Lithium in pregnancy?

RX-038

Valproate: key cautions?

RX-039

Lamotrigine: key caution?

RX-040

Carbamazepine: key cautions?

RX-034

Dietary tyramine restrictions, dangerous interactions (serotonin syndrome with SSRIs) and a washout period when switching.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-033

Highly lethal in overdose (cardiac effects), so use caution with suicidal clients. Also anticholinergic effects and dizziness on standing.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-036

Can cause serotonin syndrome with SSRIs and makes many drugs, including hormonal contraceptives, less effective.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-035

For treatment-resistant depression; given only in certified settings with about 2 hours of observation for dissociation, sedation and raised blood pressure.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2019). FDA approves new nasal spra...

RX-038

Liver toxicity, pancreatitis, weight gain, and high teratogenic risk (neural tube defects).

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-037

Teratogenic risk (Ebstein's anomaly). Refer to the prescriber; never advise stopping.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-040

Blood disorders, serious rash (higher risk with the HLA-B*1502 gene, more common in some Asian ancestries) and many drug interactions.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-039

Serious rash, including Stevens-Johnson syndrome; doses are raised slowly. A new rash needs urgent medical review.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-041

Benzodiazepine risks?

RX-042

Stopping a benzodiazepine after long daily use?

RX-043

Benzodiazepines in older adults?

RX-044

Diphenhydramine in older adults?

RX-045

Buspirone?

RX-046

'Start low, go slow' applies to whom, and why?

RX-047

Stimulants for ADHD: effects and cautions?

RX-048

Atomoxetine?

RX-042

Never abruptly: withdrawal can cause seizures. A gradual taper supervised by the prescriber is needed.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2020). FDA requiring Boxed Warning...

RX-041

Sedation, falls, memory problems and dependence. Boxed warning: dangerous breathing suppression when combined with opioids.

U.S. Food and Drug Administration (2016). FDA requires strong warnings...

RX-044

Strongly anticholinergic: confusion, delirium and urinary retention. Listed as potentially inappropriate.

American Geriatrics Society Beers Criteria Update Expert Panel (2023). A...

RX-043

Listed as potentially inappropriate: higher risk of falls, cognitive impairment and delirium.

American Geriatrics Society Beers Criteria Update Expert Panel (2023). A...

RX-046

Older adults: slower drug clearance and more medications at once. Review prescriptions against the Beers Criteria.

American Geriatrics Society Beers Criteria Update Expert Panel (2023). A...

RX-045

For generalized anxiety; not habit-forming; takes weeks to work, so it doesn't help acute panic.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-048

A non-stimulant ADHD medication with a boxed warning for suicidal thinking in youth.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-047

Work the same day. Side effects: low appetite, insomnia, headache, higher pulse and blood pressure, possible tic worsening. Risk of misuse or diversion.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-049

Guanfacine and clonidine (alpha-2 agonists)?

RX-050

Methadone for opioid use disorder?

RX-051

Buprenorphine for opioid use disorder?

RX-052

Naltrexone?

RX-053

Medications for alcohol use disorder?

RX-054

'MOUD just replaces one drug with another.' True?

RX-055

Typical alcohol withdrawal timeline?

RX-056

Wernicke encephalopathy?

RX-050

Full opioid agonist; for OUD it is dispensed through certified opioid treatment programs.

SAMHSA TIP 63 (2021) Ch. 3B: Methadone

RX-049

Used for ADHD and tics. Can cause sedation and low blood pressure; stopping suddenly can cause rebound high blood pressure.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-052

Opioid antagonist (daily pill or monthly injection) for OUD and alcohol use disorder. Requires an opioid-free period first to avoid sudden withdrawal.

SAMHSA TIP 63 (2021) Ch. 3C: Naltrexone

RX-051

Partial agonist that can be prescribed in office-based settings. The separate federal X-waiver requirement was eliminated in 2023.

SAMHSA (2023). Waiver elimination (MAT Act): removal of the DATA-wai...

RX-054

No. Medications for opioid use disorder are evidence-based treatment that lowers overdose deaths and supports recovery.

SAMHSA TIP 63 (2021) Part 1: Introduction to Medications for Opioid Use...

RX-053

Naltrexone (reduces drinking), acamprosate (supports abstinence) and disulfiram (unpleasant reaction if alcohol is used).

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-056

Confusion, unsteady gait and eye-movement problems in heavy drinkers; a thiamine-deficiency emergency.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-055

Tremor and anxiety at 6-12 hours, hallucinations at 12-24, seizures at 24-48, delirium tremens at 48-96. Needs medical management.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-057

Opioid withdrawal signs?

RX-058

Cholinesterase inhibitors (donepezil, rivastigmine, galantamine)?

RX-059

Common barriers to medication adherence?

RX-058

For Alzheimer's disease: modest symptom benefit; they do not stop the disease's progression.

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...

RX-057

Dilated pupils, yawning, runny nose, gooseflesh, aches, nausea, diarrhea. Rarely fatal, but lost tolerance raises overdose risk afterward.

DSM-5-TR (APA, 2022) Substance-Related and Addictive Disorders: Opioi...

RX-059

Side effects, cost, stigma, beliefs about medication, complex regimens and limited insight into illness (anosognosia).

Boland, Verduin & Ruiz (Eds.). Kaplan & Sadock's Synopsis of Psychiatry...